ModSecurity Solves the Manager's Dilemma

In today's world it is important to look at security beyond the network level. ModSecurity secures Web applications, which has now become the prime targets of cyber criminals.

Security has become a major concern in the wake of all the recent high profile break-ins and the resulting outcry. With mega-corporations facing embarrassing attacks, it looks like no company is safe from cyber-attacks these days. In the old days, networks were targeted in the hope that some weakness (read vulnerability) would be found, which would help cyber criminals (as opposed to 'hackers', who don't perform such malicious stuff!) get into a machine and steal data. However, now, Web and mobile applications are the prime targets.

Studies from Gartner show that 70 per cent of the threats are at the application layer. While other respected application security companies like White Hat and security groups like Web Application Security Consortium (WASC) estimate that the average number of vulnerabilities in a Web application is 12-13, US-based Ponemon Institute claims that around 73 per cent of organisations have been hacked through insecure Web applications (*http://www.mykonossoftware.com/statistics.php*).

Protecting Web applications is not only a security imperative, it is also good business sense unless you want to get sued by clients who discover that they are vulnerable because you have put an unprotected Web application on your network, which is accessible from the Internet!

ModSecurity can help you stay secure, with little or no cost (there will be some cost while calculating the total cost of ownership, which we will get to in the later part of this article).

What is ModSecurity?

It is a Web application firewall (more specifically, a Web application firewall module on Apache Web server), which sits between your application and the whole world out there, and will try to protect your application from being sabotaged or owned.